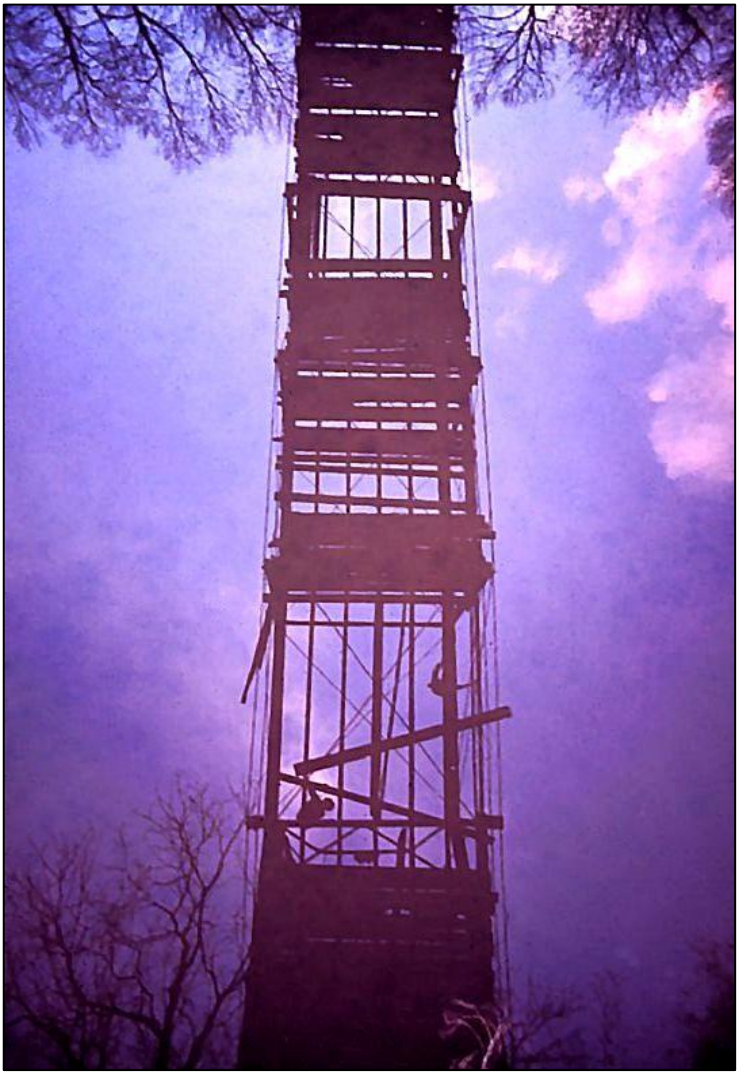
The Art of Lucid Dreaming



From *The Consciousness Chronicles* by Jack Lamb, available on Amazon.com

1 — My introduction to Astral Projection

I never heard of *Astral Projection* or *Lucid Dreaming* until Buzz brought his new girlfriend Terry Denton down to Singing Stones to meet us; and she mentioned it as we cozily sipped mulled wine around the fireplace later that evening. Because of the bitterly cold winter weather and the deep snow obscuring the two-mile-long primitive road out, as well as the exigency to ford the three-foot-deep ice-covered stream; Nancy suggested they spend the night in our loft. And while the vibrant young woman thought it a splendid idea, our close friend professed indecision.

"It's so quiet here! Sleeping in this house would be perfect for dreamwalking!" Terry pleaded to coax him.

Looking to Buzz for an explanation of dreamwalking, I saw him lift both palms up in repudiation. "Don't look at me; ask Terry. It's not within my areas of expertise."

Nodding at the wall of books illuminated by the glow of kerosene lamps, she chided me impishly. "Seriously, you must have at least *one* book about dreamwalking?"

"I don't." I confessed, rueful at her mischievous dig.

"Well, dreamwalking is what it sounds like; walking consciously in a dream." She explained matter-of-factly.

"And you've done this?" I asked with keen interest.

After she nodded her assent, I squinted at Buzz for corroboration; and tilting his head towards his girlfriend, he answered noncommittally. "This is the first I've heard of it. But knowing Terry; I wouldn't put it past her."

"How's it done?" I inquired just as a huge oak log balanced between the brace of andirons broke and fell, spreading an eruption of embers on the hearth.

"It's not easy… but it's not difficult either if you know how to start." Terry contended as I grabbed the shovel to scoop up the coals and toss them into the fire.

"Being awake while sleeping is paradoxical." Buzz weighed in with bemused pragmatic skepticism.

"You can't dreamwalk if you're asleep, silly!" She scolded him as if this truth was obvious. "You have to awaken *inside* the dream before you can dreamwalk."

"If you're awake, then how can you be dreaming?" Nancy chimed in from the rocking chair beside Buzz.

"That's the trick…" Terry conceded. "You need to awaken in the dream without actually waking up."

Nancy frowned suspiciously at her reply, while Buzz rolled his eyes upward without moving his head to stare at the peak of the 22-foot-tall chimney. However, I found her assertion intriguing; and wanted to learn more.

"It seems like it would be difficult, if not impossible, to become conscious in a dream." I mused thoughtfully. "I can't imagine how to even begin to accomplish it."

"I can tell you how it works for me." Terry offered.

"Ah, please do…" Buzz interjected judiciously.

"Haven't you ever fallen in a dream?" She asked. "I mean, fallen out of a tree or plummeted out of the sky?" All three of us nodded affirmatively.

"And what happened when you fell?" Terry pressed.

"I always wake up." Nancy replied, after which Buzz and I quickly nodded our agreement.

"The next time you fall, don't wake up and *leave the dream*; instead, wake up *in the dream*." Terry asserted.

Several months later, she gifted me a book on astral projection entitled *Journeys out of the Body* by Robert A. Monroe (Doubleday, New York 1971). And during the

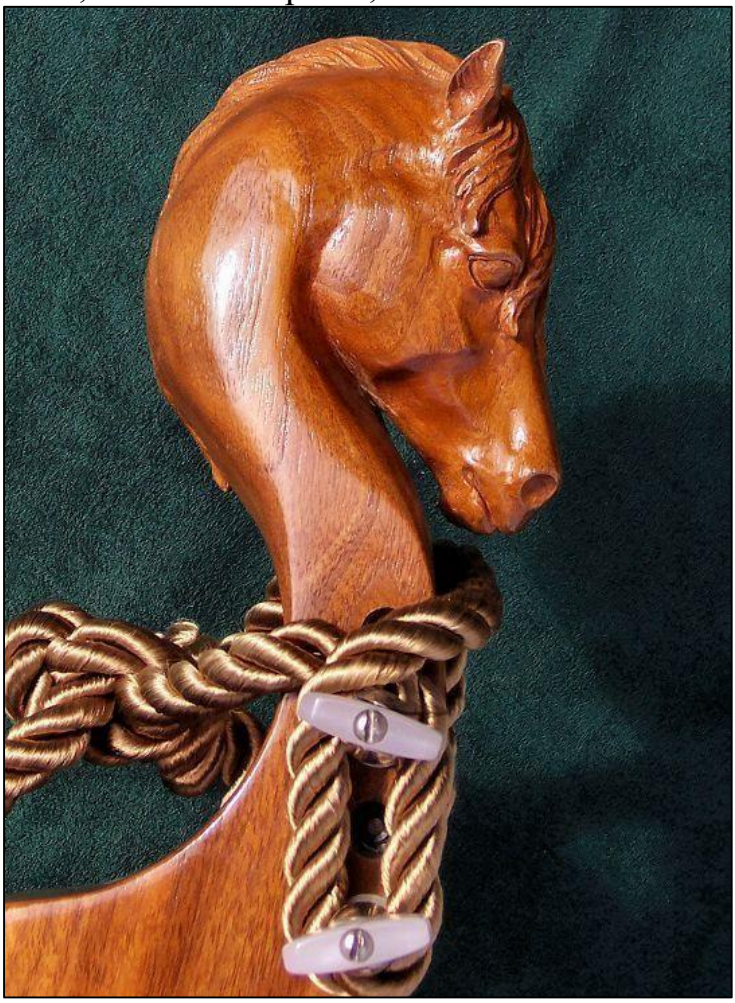
next few years as we became friends, we often discussed dreamwalking, Terry as my mentor and me as her pupil.

I diligently meditated on astral projection each night before I slept. But perhaps because I generally only slept two or three hours a day, I had trouble dreaming, let alone dreamwalking. So by the time I haphazardly managed to awaken consciously in a dream a year later, in her dreams Terry nightly flew fully conscious over mountains, rivers, and forests in euphoric lucidity.

Nocturnally consciously projecting her astral body in a lucid dream was an end in itself for her, so Terry never wanted to explore the dream world in any other way; nor would she ever have forced herself into another person's dream. Innocently lacking the foibles plaguing the rest of us, she entirely lived within her present temporality.

In many ways, she reminded me of a wood nymph or a Naiad, wide-eyed and attentive to everything happening around her, but ready to take flight into the protection of the forest at the crack of a snapped twig. Truthfully, she lived as if she had but a single foot within our reality; and seemed to be able to look into worlds only she could see. An amazing woodcarver, Terry could carve anything from memory, as if she actually did study the creatures of Nature through a portal in her mind's eye. Additionally, she was an accomplished musician capable of playing by ear practically any musical instrument she picked up, and make it resonate in otherworldly ways. This may be why

even now two score years later; her haunting syncopated flailed-banjo melodies still drift through my recollection. I will forever prize the striking Arabian horse headblock she carved atop the exquisite mountain dulcimer made of rosewood, walnut and spruce, which Buzz crafted for me.



I lost touch with Terry after she went to work for the National Geographic Magazine in Washington, DC. But I often wondered how her wildling spirit fared confined within the concrete and steel of the nation's capital. And I worried about whether her innocent wonderment might have become world-wearied by the stark materialism of the automatonic drones she encountered in the city.

Some years later, I unexpectedly received a postcard from her, scribbled with a worrisome and nearly illegible supplication to come and dreamwalk with her.

Life is hard here and I am fading…
Come and meet me in my dreams…
I will be the disembodied spirit…
Floating above Washington, DC…

Out-of-body experiences were never my forte, to soar disembodied as a spirit through the commonplace reality in which we customarily live. So although I tried several times to meet her in my dreams, I never succeeded. Then not many months later, I received word from Buzz that Terry had died from an overdose of sleeping pills.

A bit of magic fled the world the day she passed.

∞

The National Geographic Magazine article *An Ozark Family Carves a Living and a Way of Life* (vol. 146, no. 1, page 124, July 1975) written and photographed by Bruce Dale, includes photographs of Terry and many of the woodcarvings she sculpted while she still lived with her family in a log cabin built by her father Ivan deep in the North Arkansas mountains.

2 — Dream guides and Lucid Dreams

Perhaps I never tried to follow a path towards out-of-body experiences, as did Terry; because I saw too many parallels between dreams and the altered states of reality I experienced on hallucinogenic substances. For in truth, astral projection is better suited to a serene and observant perspective such as hers; whereas I tend to dive headlong into an altered state of reality and explore it from within.

Several books implied it was very important to find a dream guide if I was to make any progress in becoming conscious in my dreams; and I did eventually encounter two. The first guide I chanced upon wore a coarse robe over which a curly white beard draped to his midsection.

My guide never actually spoke to me nor I to him, for we communicated telepathically in existential gestalts of interrogation and understanding. Thus, I simply formed a question, honestly not more than a directed query. And before I could express it in words, I parapsychologically sensed an equally nonverbal response akin to an inherent, profound comprehension; comparable to the way I might have felt had my answer been mundanely vocalized.

It is extremely difficult even now to put my telepathic discussion with this dream guide into words. But when I left him, I no longer had doubts about the dream world being any less viable than the waking world, and just as feasible a medium for existence. Thus, based on this encounter, I acquired the confidence I required to become lucidly conscious in my dreams henceforth.

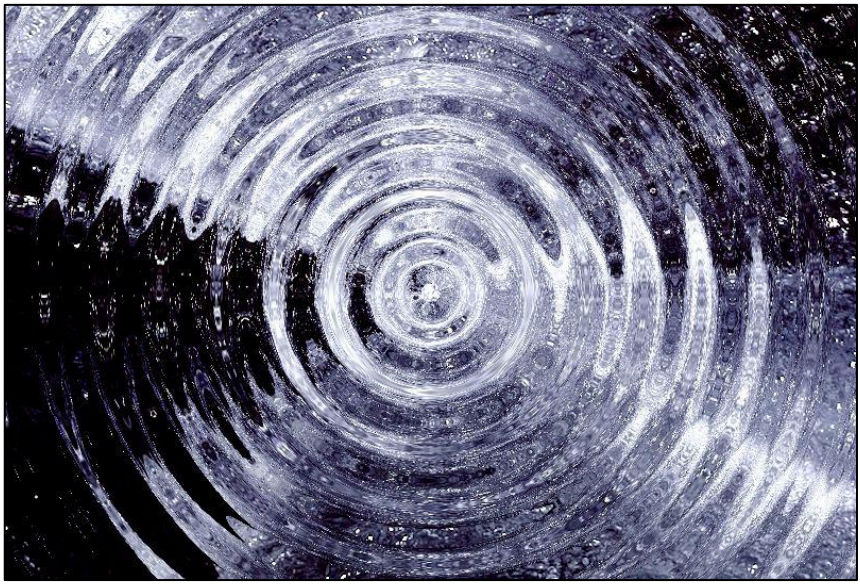
Straightforward to comprehend, but insanely difficult to put into practice; if I were actually to awaken, I had to sublimate my awareness in my dreams; for the power one commands by being absolutely conscious tends to modify the dream reality just as overpoweringly as an enormous tidal wave will inundate a coastline. So, the trick I had to learn was to contain my consciousness completely, while still being aware of its substantiation in the dream world; and if I had to act at all, it must be through assimilating a subliminal intent no greater than the wisp of a thought.

Trust me when I say it took decades truly to learn to sublimate my ego to where my full consciousness could persist extant in a dream, and not surprisingly, given the

requisite *modus operandi* I must employ, I usually found myself a passive observer. Still, with my consciousness ensconced within a dream body I sometimes identify as me and other times as a different personality, I am able to examine my surroundings, the other performers, and our interactions with astute perspicacity. As a result, in each nightly instantiation, my dream realities can become just as real as my experiences in my waking world; offering indistinguishably analogous sensory interactions.

In passing, the second time I met a dream guide in a dream, like a neophyte I peculiarly demanded validation for wisdom I acquired the first time; so not unreasonably, he dismissively turned his back on me. It ultimately took a long time to encounter another dream guide; although it occurs to me, I might have avoided a third encounter out of lingering mortification at my earlier importunity.

The methodology I learned from my original dream guide about how to maintain my consciousness in a dream reality is surprisingly effectually identical to what I have named my *Artifice of Assimilation*. The reason for this enigma is that years before I grasped the parallel procedure in dreams, I had already expertly mastered it in my waking reality. Hence, I often question whether I might have ultimately learned to awaken my consciousness in a lucid dream as proficiently, had I not expended so much of my cognizance employing an artifice of assimilation in my waking reality to manifest a future temporality in alignment with my conscious intent.



During my lifelong quest to discern the true nature of consciousness, I ascertained how intention is determined within our individual time continuums, and why one fate will take precedent over other potential outcomes. And I chanced to comprehend how to ensure that my intent will be ambiguously manifested into reality as an actuality at an indeterminate forthcoming point in time; by planting a vectored seed of conscious intent, frankly no more than a pre-thought sliding unseen along the temporal continuum unchecked, until it manifests within my future destiny.

Subsequently, to manifest outcomes conducive to the attainment of my metaphysical objectives I envision a progression to channel me through the unfathomable forest of unconscious hedonistic materialism life exploits to capture awareness; by using a process I call an *Artifice of*

Assimilation. Employing this pacific procedure, I never attempt to focus my conscious intent on a single specific pathway through the myriads of imaginable temporalities lying potentially before me; but simply encourage a potentiality to manifest in the manner I ultimately expect by focusing my resolve on the distant and virtually obscure horizon of future possibilities.

The act of living ensnares us in a web of constricting limitations from which it is nearly impossible to extricate ourselves. But no matter how convoluted the intricacy of an eventual situation might become, there is a moment in our awareness of an approaching course of actuality at its outset, when the eventuality is only a fleeting inclination, requiring no more than an attentive conscious meditation to manifest, modify or redirect intent. Thus, contemplating the potentialities branching from a present instant in my timeline, I ponder pathways of predilection to assimilate my intention within the predetermined course of my life.

This is the easiest stage of manifesting a future intent. What is considerably more challenging is to maintain the requisite of allowing an intention to travel its preordained course without further guidance from my consciousness; for it is our penchant to impose our fears on any intended objective, which unavoidably redirects its manifestation.

Knowing how to manifest future change consciously is not the transcendental power it may seem to fulfill our dreams and desires. For in the process of acquiring this knowledge, it liberates us from the shackles our world

places on us; to crave for so many *things* the acquisition thereof occupies what little consciousness we possess.

Once I grasped how the substantive physicalities of reality are fashioned from the constituents of matter and energy infused with binding filaments of consciousness, it eliminated the cravings, desires and lusts I affected for people, possessions, fame or fortune; replacing them with an exacting comprehension concerning our responsibility as perspicacious conscious beings to envision, create and maintain a compassionate reality free of dissonance.

Abstractly, this is no easy task; for the metaphysical conceptual constructs defining reality involuntarily create diametric opposites in *time*, which make one take pause concerning the ethicality of conceiving and creating any change at all. For example, the conceptualization of *heat* perforce dictates the existence of its opposite, *cold*, and the manifestation of the actuality of *wealth* unavoidably creates the obverse state of *poverty*; just as surely, as the conceptualization of *life* generates the certainty of *death*.

This is the Catch-22 of our reality. If we elect to exercise the inexhaustible inspiration a boundless consciousness affords us, then we should be omniscient about the ultimate effects of our actions before we decide to tweak a twig or thoughtlessly bend a bough.

By consciously assimilating our present temporalities with those in our past via recollection, each of us should be prophetically able to perceive the predominant nexus points causally leading to potential future states of being.

Since dreams juxtapose us within parallel or alternative realities, similar if not the same as the ones in which we customarily live, they are excellent vehicles for this methodology of interdimensional communication. And as I have also learned, it is equally possible for us to communicate with the future and past instantiations of our *selves* through the conduit of consciousness connecting the perceptivities of our recollections and preordained proclivities transpiring within our uniquely individual timelines, enduringly extant and accessible from a fifth-dimensional perspectivity.

The term lucid dream applies to a dream in which the dreamer is consciously aware that he or she is dreaming.

The Dutch psychiatrist Frederik van Eeden (1860 – 1932) coined the phrase. He advocated that in lucid

dreams; the dreamer wields control over his participation within the dream by manipulating the experiences imagined in the dream environment. The psychiatrist maintained a lucid dream could be as realistic and vivid as ordinary reality.

While it may be possible for some dreamers to enter a lucid dream on demand when they lay down to sleep, as yet I cannot. I have however, learned to reenter any lucid dream on awakening, as many times as deemed necessary to reexamine the scenes in startling detail just as I learned to eidetically recall recollections of the past events I have lived to astutely reassess their aspects and intricacies. I might add that while I cannot lucidly dream on cue on laying down to sleep, the frequency with which I dream lucidly appears to increase with every dream I experience. Not counting dreams, I might have infused with my consciousness but did not, fully two-thirds of the dreams I now experience are extraordinarily lucid.

The concept of lucid dreaming was not widely known when the Swiss psychotherapist Carl Jung (1875 – 1961) advanced his innovative hypotheses about the collective unconscious, dream analysis, and dream symbolization. Jung believed, while the personal unconscious is unique to each individual, the collective unconscious taps into a reservoir of archetypal memories unique to each species. Therefore, while our dreams may often be comprised of direct memories of people and places from our personal experience; additionally, images dreamed may represent

archetypal remnants emanating from the deepest recesses of our genetic memories within a collective unconscious.

Concepts such as the *anima* and *animus*, the *shadow*, the *great mother*, and the *wise old man* represent motifs, which may vary a great deal without losing its instinctual symbolic pattern to provide momentous transition during rites of passage from one stage of life to the next; marked by archetypal events such as birth, death, separation from parents and marriage. Jung believed these archetypes act as symbols of our unconscious attitudes in our dreams, in essence, hidden from the conscious mind as autonomous manifestations perceived by every dreamer as personages outside of self. The advent of these archetypes in dreams increases our awareness of our unconscious attitudes and assimilates contrasting parts of our psyches; contributing ultimately to a more holistic self-understanding which in fact, is precisely the effect lucid dreams have on me.

So how can you learn to dream lucidly, and tap into the genetic memories of Jung's collective unconscious?

To awaken fully conscious in a dream it is important to set up cues to snap awake. As mentioned, falling is an excellent cue that works more times than not, but almost anything that startles us to take stock of the dream reality in which we persist, works equally well. Thus, spotting my reflection in a mirror, a pane of glass, or a pool of water recurrently snaps me conscious: sometimes because I see myself at unexpected ages, and other times because I do

not recognize myself at all. Additionally, more and more I find the act of looking for something I cannot find will similarly bring me into wakefulness. And any time I find myself or another person threatened in a dream, my full consciousness immediately precipitates, subsequently allowing me to incise or dissolve the perilous threat from my dream reality, and thereby render it a non sequitur.

Of course, a dream in which I ingest a hallucinogenic substance awakens me to an altered state of reality indistinguishable from the other waking trips on mind-altering drugs I experienced in my youth. Reality in these lucid dreams can change starkly so rapidly, they can seem like struggling to stay ahorse a bucking bronco while at the same time riding in an out-of-control rollercoaster through scenes cut from hundreds of movies randomly edited

together. The only reason I can maintain my continuity of consciousness in these tripping dreams is because decades past, I learned how to subsist in altered states triggered by psychotropic influences. And so, I recall details no matter how aberrant or unimaginable.

Ultimately, I believe the cues we use to awaken in a dream will vary in accordance with the life experiences we have had in our waking reality, our prior dreams, and the altered states we have known. Just look for things or events that startle you enough to make you look twice, for it is in the act of focusing on a detail in a dream that allows consciousness to suffuse it with self-awareness.

Decades ago, living at Singing Stones and practicing dreamwalking each night, before I fell asleep, I meditated

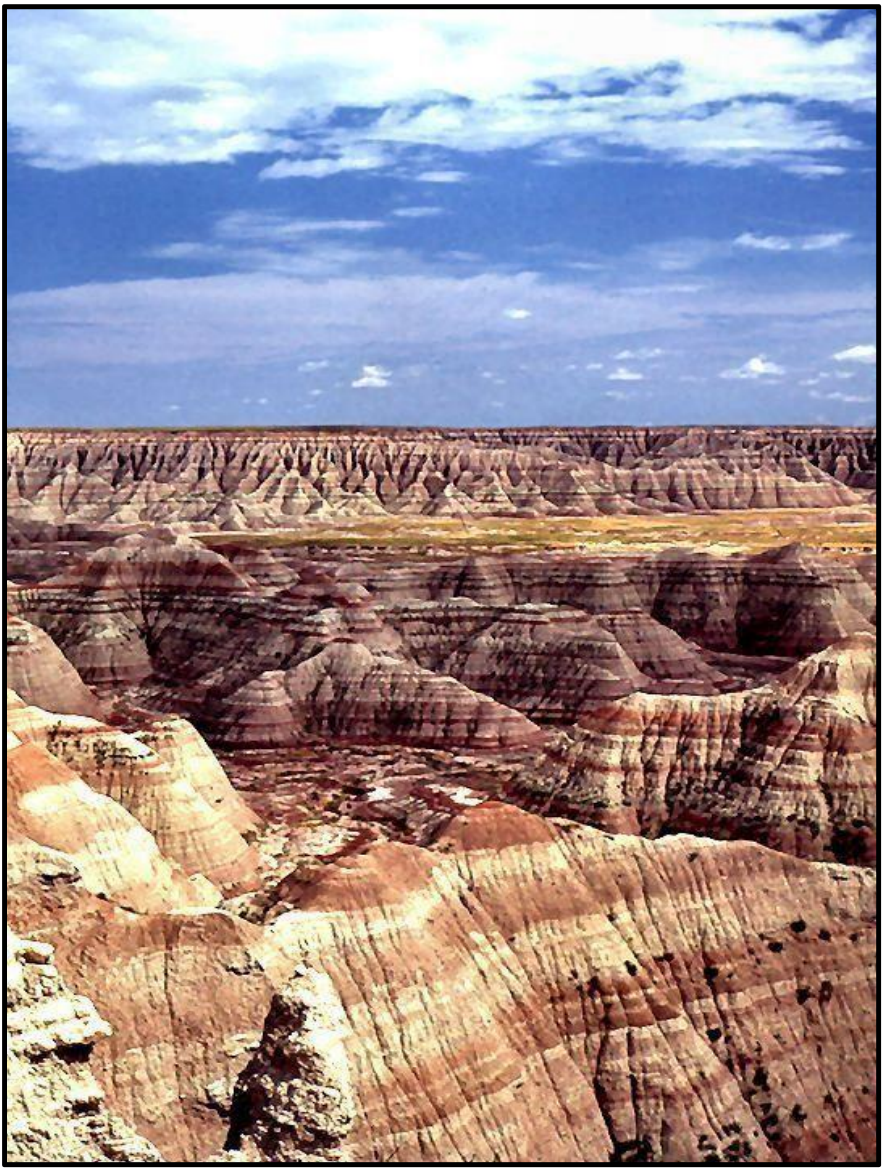
on using fear in a dream as my spiritual trigger to prompt me to awaken to full consciousness. I do not know how long I practiced this technique; but it ultimately worked.

Now, a side effect of waking consciously in a dream is we customarily know we are asleep; so there is nothing actually to fear. And in the decades since, I have become lucidly conscious so frequently, I no longer have a doubt I can control a dream's outcome; if not with my thoughts, then with the wizardly powers the dream reality offers a fully conscious entity. Hence, the sense of fear I once used to awaken in my dreams eventually stopped being useful.

Typically, when I experience fear in a dream, it is for someone in the dream who was in trouble. But I rarely feel fear for myself. Oddly, fearing for a dream person still usually makes me conscious. And perhaps because of who I am, I usually go to the trouble of assisting him or her; if not in that moment in the dream timeline, then in a 'replay' dream I initiate immediately after I awaken.

Be aware, fear peculiarly is also the emotion, which may prevent us from experiencing lucid dreams; for the fear of falling or of dying, or of confronting an unknown threat, or a known but dreaded situation, can also coerce us to waken in bed rather than in the dream if we are not vigilant. Consequently, I recommend that once you are comfortable with your ability to awaken reliably in a dream, you begin replacing fear as a dream trigger, and

eliminate fright from your conscious and unconscious psyches.



I have never found anything in a dream that I could not overcome with consciousness. Just be tolerant with your present limitations in dreams, and in time you will lose your fears and be able to enjoy the wonderment of this threshold into an infinity of parallel realities with the equivalent degree of consciousness you employ in your waking life.

The last point I want to mention is how to remember a lucid dream after you have experienced it. For me, the easiest way to remember every nuance of lucidity is by reviewing the dream in precise detail repeatedly for thirty to forty-five minutes. I also find it works equally well to reenter and continue the earlier dream several times in a semi-somnolent state between wakefulness and sleep, to instill it more profoundly into my conscious recollection.

Lastly, at least originally, I recommend you write the dream down using as much detail as you remember when you arise from bed before you forget them. For while I clearly recall lucid dreams experienced even as a boy that I never wrote down, they are generally no more than a short sequence of existential frames without any real temporal duration in change. Consequently, for me, writing down each and every insignificant detail I can remember, and then reading each dream account recurrently for several days to ferret out and transcribe supplementary details which subsequently come to mind, forever instills the lucid dream within my memory.

I confess, spending two or three hours each morning scribing my lucid dreams from one day to the next can be quite tedious, especially on consecutive days. However, you might find a friend or family member also interested in dreams willing to read what you write down; and then in turn, send you their lucid dreams for your surveillance. A longtime good friend and I send each other every notable dream we experience, lucid or otherwise. Personally, I find knowing someone else will read my dream account goads me to get memories down on paper, no matter how much I would rather blow it off.

Several of my more incredible lucid dreams are transcribed in the ensuing chapters, including my resultant waking *stream of consciousness* interpretation regarding each occurrence. Perhaps, these accounts of mine own dreams, and my subsequent reflections about what each meant to me, will provide a tangy taste of the rich alternate realities waiting for you once you learn to practice, and master, *The Art of Lucid Dreaming*.

In case you wonder as you read, there is a reason why my dream accounts resemble any remembered detailed recollection a novelist might narrate in a book; rather than one of those invariably terse summaries transcribed in any reputable dream journal recounting the dreams recorded in an empirically controlled dream study. For my memories of my lucid dreams are just as eidetically inculcated within my present temporality as the real-life waking recollections I routinely consciously recall.

3 — Several somewhat short lucid dreams

I think what sometimes prevents me from recalling my lucid dreams are the outright bizarreness of many of them. One night I had trouble recalling a particularly odd dream when I awakened. And after attempting to refresh my memory three separate times; even then I almost lost all recollections of the dream after I arose from my bed.

Lizard Symbiotics

In this dream, I visited my brother Dale who lived in a jungle reality based on lizard symbiotics. For example, he kept a compliant lizard in his dresser, which somehow magically kept clothes clean and fresh. And the woman

who lived with him in the dream employed another lizard to produce water to wash dishes. For I witnessed the outsized reptile generate a sphere of humidity overhead, which coalesced into a cloud generating a tiny rainstorm precisely over the sink. All the lizards in his house were quite docile, and seemingly fully attuned to the symbiotic relationship they sustained with their human companions.

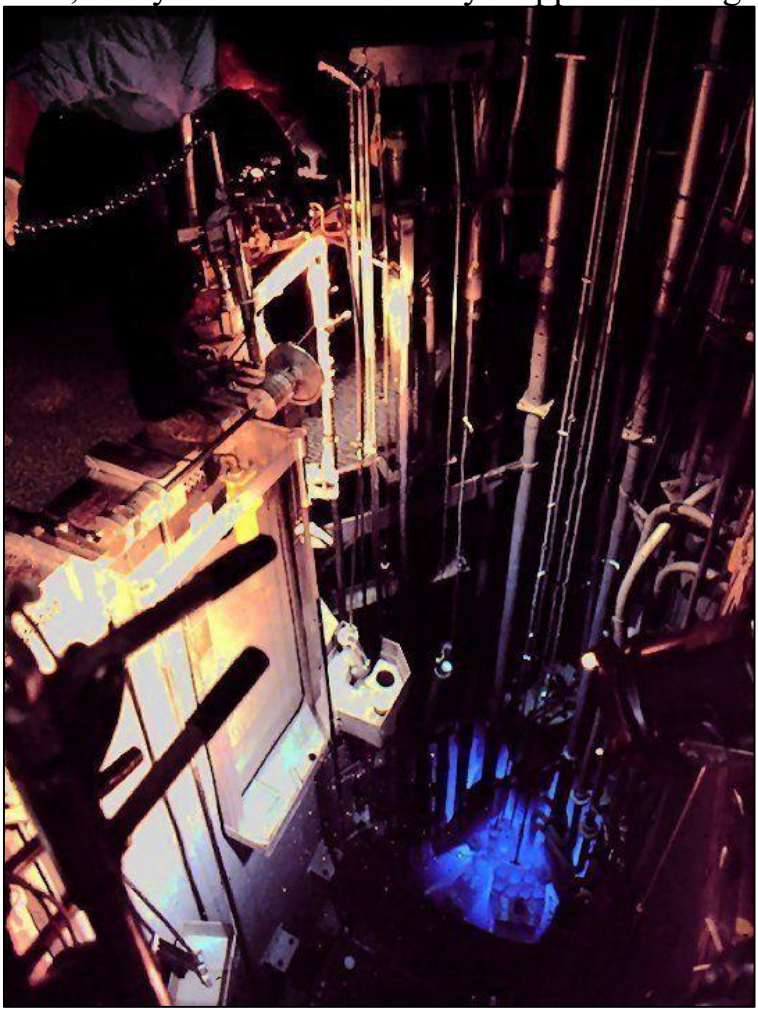
I can assure you I have never read such a storyline, so I must assume my dreams are so far outside reality even I sometimes have trouble recollecting them. That said; it is considerably easier to awaken in an obviously aberrant dream, since the witnessed peculiarities regularly startle me into immediate consciousness.

Repairing an Alien Power Plant

I had another dream where I was working at a power generation plant in an aboriginal alternate reality. Their technology was not solid state or even mechanical. Yet I understood how it should have functioned by consciously examining the alien intricacies of its apparencies, before subsequently reconstructing the broken components that rendered the plant barely operable many centuries ago.

The creatures working at the power plant were not trained or even intelligent. Nevertheless, I found a pair of males astute enough to learn the assembly procedure I devised to keep the plant operational after I awakened.

I rebuilt six or seven of the components, which had failed generations ago, severely limiting their production of power. Urgently hastening to finish the task before I awakened, when an end of work whistle unexpectedly sounded, every worker immediately stopped working.



When the laborers began leaving, I tried convincing them to remain long enough for me to finish the last few components so we could get them reinstalled; but they refused. I could have gotten the power plant working at 60% instead of the 30% it produced, but the dimwitted creatures seemed innately unable to deviate from their daily patterns of behavior long enough for me to teach them how to overhaul the components on their own. So, with a distinct sense of frustration, I watched their alien reality slowly dissolve when I forced myself awake.

This dream possessed so much detail I actually had to assemble the components one after the other, minute by minute in real time. Thus, if what Gurdjieff said about how few minutes the average person is conscious a day is true, then I persisted fully conscious for a prolonged duration in this dream. As this was the last in a series of working-class dreams, I had been experiencing, it made me wonder if their intent was to practice focusing and strengthening my consciousness while submerged in a dream reality.

Learning the Way of the Monk

Sometimes after I dream, none is striking enough to bring it to my awareness when I awaken. However, one night I had two lucid dreams that subsequently awakened me. In the first, I observed a novitiate friar attempting to follow Gurdjieff's *Way of the Monk*; and in the second, I

was the monastic cleric attempting to follow the *Way of the Monk* based on my discerning observations surveyed in the first of this paired set of lucid dreams.

The reason why I refer to these dreams as *The Way of the Monk* is that both visions involved the correct way to hold one's hands in prayer. Apparently, just holding my hands, palms together with elbows affixed at my sides as I learned as a child growing up Catholic, is improper.

So in the dream, I had to practice holding my elbows out horizontally to each side, and perpendicular to palms vertically pressed together. With my unwavering dream instructor demanding I achieve perfection, the distressing position was extremely agonizing to maintain. As I think about this dream as I write, it prompts me to recall why I would never willingly live as a monk in a monastery.

∞

Transcendence into a Quantum Universe

I am not sure why occasionally I cannot dream at all; although, it may be a consequence of spending so many hours working on one or another creative project, it overpowers my consciousness to the exclusion of all else. Nevertheless, I know my dreams will eventually resume; as they did on the night I oddly slept for over eight hours. I faced a weekend gathering with a group comprised of fifteen intellectual friends and their significant others. It seemed as if I was a thirty-something, as was everyone else

in the house. With so much discourse and energetic sharing going on around me, I knew this crowd would be able to understand the intricacies of quantum reality if I decided to share it with them. And in the blending of our spirits, aptitudes and abilities, it seemed conceivable we might be able to open our collective consciousness to the wonders of the quantum universe for all to witness.

For my part in preparing supper with all my friends, I sliced a large block of blue cheese that made my mouth water; until precipitously I realized I should be preparing my presentation so its central points about reality would make sense to everyone. Then as I began rehearsing what I wanted to say, I found myself unexpectedly merging and meshing with the existentiality of the quantum universe; my consciousness entwining with the matter and energy

whirling around me as I floated in black space, until time stopped and temporality no longer had meaning.

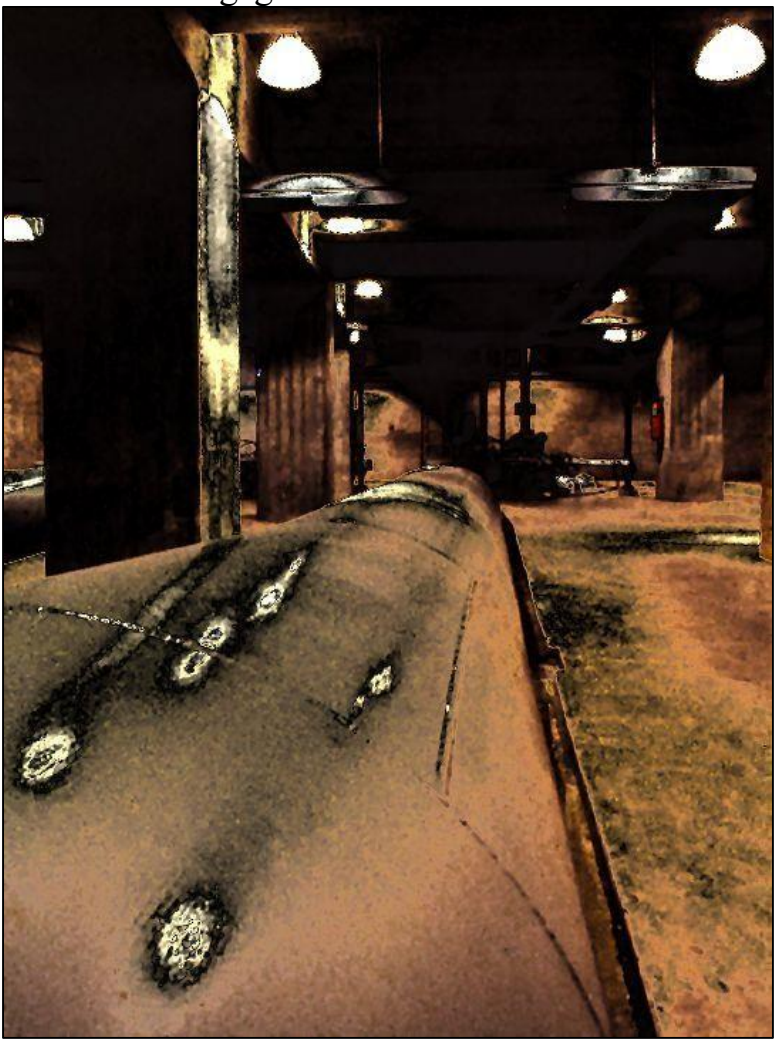
As my last sentient thought in this dream, I realized I must have precipitately ejaculated my consciousness into the quantum universe before I had the occasion to share it with my collected friends through my presentation. But then, I realized they orbited around me, experiencing the same existentialism as me; apparently pulled along in the tow of my tide. What a remarkably transcendent dream!

A World of Wetness and Ice

I had another alternate reality dream in which I lived on a frozen and wet, sparsely populated planet. Because nothing would combust in its atmosphere the people were largely nomadic, journeying from one temporary thermal spout to another for the heat it provided them. The catch with living on this planet, we were always wet; and when the thermal geysers erratically receded, it was god-awful miserable to be cold and wet for days. I usually worked with two females; repairing pipes connected to the only enduring deep thermal wellspring from which steaming water pumped to a mammoth cavern housing a relatively small number of elites who controlled the civilization.

While in the field, we conversed with the cavern base through communication devices. Eccentrically, everyone worshiped an individual named Scott Strauss and treated

him as a demigod. Males and females incessantly gossiped about him, as if his was the only notable life on a planet where survival engaged the sum of human consciousness.



Near the end of the dream, my coworkers and I found a break in the main pipe where it followed the length of a

narrow foot bridge spanning a deep abyss. And so much boiling water ejected from the rupture, lacking additional pipe it was impossible for the three of us to make repairs. We needed support, so one of my colleagues called the cavern. But before she could report, the person on the other end informed her aghast that Scott Strauss was a computer-generated construct and not a living person.

Both the females working with me were so distraught over the news they collapsed to the ground and refused to get up. Suddenly the hot water spewing from the broken pipe turned ice cold, and I knew the perpetual heat source for the cavern had permanently cooled, thereby marking the inevitable end of civilization on this planet. Soaking wet and too teeth-clatteringly cold to survive, I crumpled to the earth in despair beside my disconsolate coworkers.

∞

Dream Lucidity through Game Design

One night I found myself in a lengthy serial dream in which I helped a young game designer with the theory of computer gaming. Each time I dropped back asleep after I awakened, I found myself in a subsequent meeting with the young man listening to his theories. Our encounters spanned several months; with every dream rendered in exquisite detail, comprising every sense including touch.

For example, while sitting on a couch watching the programmers work and listening to the young designer, I

even felt the cushions depress when he sat down next to me. Except for the peripheral cloudiness circumscribing my sight, I would have thought I persisted in my real life.

The eighth or ninth time I was about to reenter and reiterate the dream sequence, I halted half in wakefulness and half in dream, and proceeded to move back and forth; deeper into dream and back into wakeful reality to study the effect. Uncontestably, my consciousness transported elsewhere; but that somewhere was more akin to sitting at a table *looking at a microscope*, before *looking into the microscope* to distinguish the alternative reality revealed at the infinitesimal level on the microscope slide.

Consequently, there was no change in physical place; rather I merely focused an alternative way on something existing extant within the same specious space. It proved to be a significant learning experience; perhaps instigated by the repetitive run-throughs I practiced, while entering and leaving the illusory reality of this lucid set of dreams.

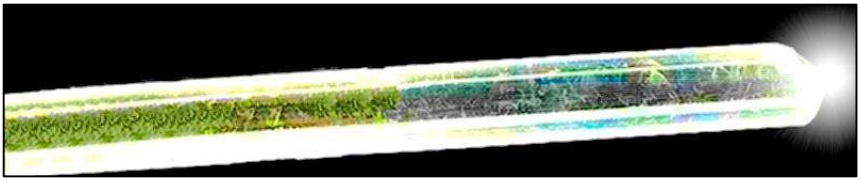
∞

A Weapon to Fight Oppression

I also vividly remember a lucid dream taking place in a desert devoid of nearly all vegetation. The population lived isolated from one another in gypsy-like carts; oddly always parked adjacent to piled straw placed in globular mangers, presumably for feeding whatever animal pulled the roofed tumbrils across the parched landscape.

My task was to organize these people, who dressed in desert robes, against an unnamed oppressor. But try as I might I had no success in getting anyone to speak to me; and every time I tried, he or she hurried away.

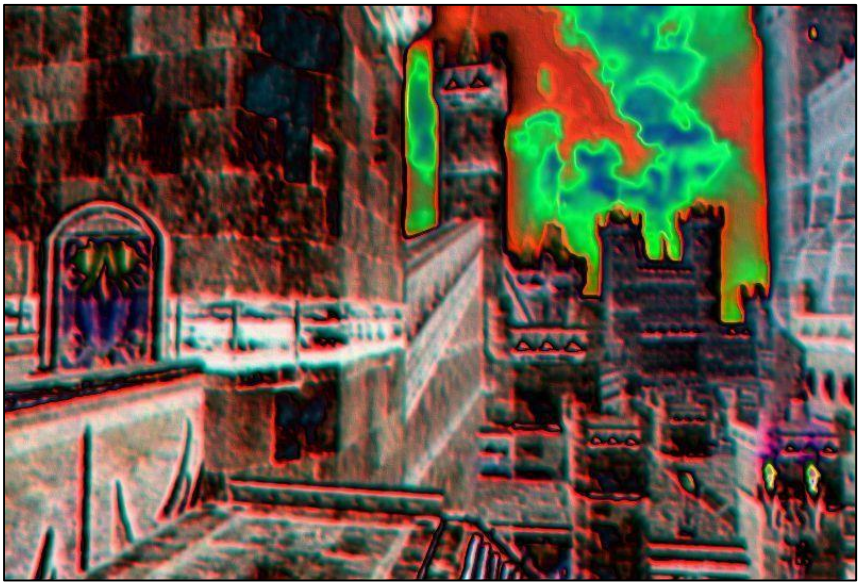
After nightfall, a man unexpectedly appeared and led me to a manmade depression, a hollowed earthen cavity where people clustered around a spectral robed sorceress. This portentous woman pulled me aside and revealed an elongated glowing crystalline shard, which she claimed, held the power I would need to marshal the inhabitants of this desert world to fight against their oppressors.



Suddenly, the woman felt a presence approaching out of the darkness encircling the isolated concavity in which we all stood. And before I could see anything concrete, a brilliant light erupted upwards from the crystalline shard in her hand spreading outward in a conical parabolic arch to create an umbrella of brilliance over the circumference of the bowl, illuminating and revealing imprecise shapes; moving just beyond its indistinctly obscured perimeter.

Perhaps too much happened too fast because I sensed myself receding from the dream, not in fear but in shock.

As the dream dissipated, I awakened, only to wonder if I might have used the shard to free the people.



4 — An epic confrontation against a demon

My dreams transformed during those years we lived at Singing Stones; becoming progressively further lucid, detailed and intricate with each passing month. Soon my bursts of lucidity experienced within dreams became epic in proportion as I learned to maneuver consciously within my dream realities; assessing the fit of my consciousness within my dream persona to limit the intent of my actions so each dream reality maintained the causal continuity I required to manifest persistent and tempered change.

As the next dream illustrates, sometimes dreams can seem dangerously bizarre. But if the dreamer can remain fearless when threatened by an insurmountable menace, it

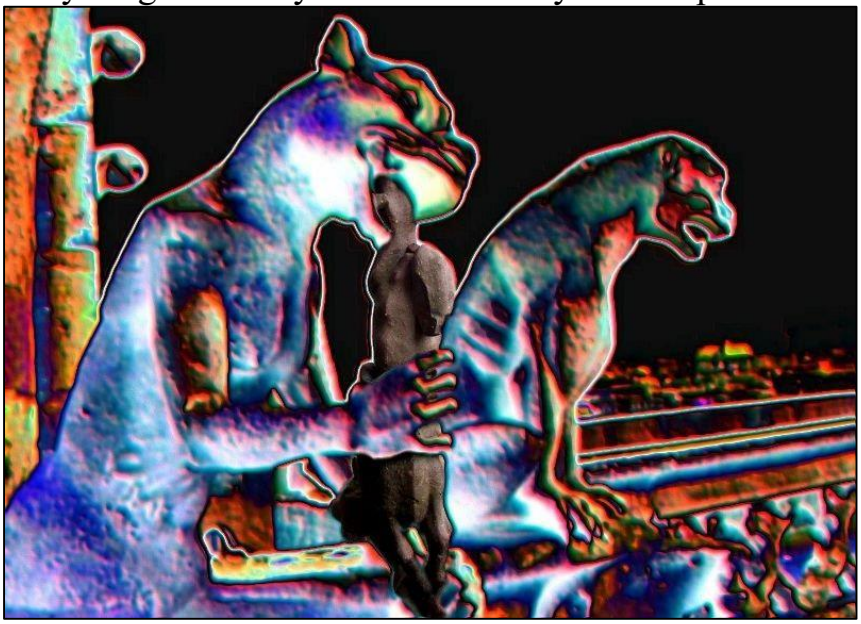
may provide a perfect opportunity to employ ostensibly magical extrasensory influence over the dream details by utilizing consciousness to warp and bend reality at will.

I had a vivid dream that called into play most of what I learned during the course of my life to keep my balance and wits in the face of unexpected peril. Contrary to my nature, I found myself in a battle against a demon named Belial; one I engaged briefly while dreaming during the last months I lived at Singing Stones after Nancy left.

In those bygone days before there was an Internet, it was difficult to look up random data, so I never knew if this demon was a figment of my imagination, a historical credibility, or a demon spawn some priest or nun used to scare the bejesus out of little kids when I was young. Consequently. while writing this chronicle in the year 2013, I looked up Belial on Google and learned he is no less than one of the four crowned princes of Hell, and a major demon in the Bible. Perversely, the name translates as 'worthless' in ancient Hebrew. Nevertheless, if you look it up, you will learn that Belial is no minor manifestation of evil.

I dreamed my real self into a walled fortress made of stone in the company of a group of men and women, also plucked here against their will. Listening to some of the others argue with one another, it was clear we all knew we were here to band together to fight Belial. However, as no one had any stomach for a confrontation, it looked as if procrastination would be the battle plan of the day.

Everyone talked at once demanding we find a way out of our stronghold, but from my earlier clash I knew Belial manipulated reality at will; thus, the citadel itself was an illusion that likely would metamorph without warning. And from my recollections of my earlier encounter with the demon, I inherently knew any one of our contingent could be an illusion; or even an aspect of the fiend. Thus. everything and everyone in this reality was suspect.



One of the men pointed up at a break in the wall and yelled, "Look!" And as we all watched, the stone transformed into an aperture iris, and then an oblique breach to the outside. Looking thru the gap, I saw a pair of crescent moons, one above the other in a black sky.

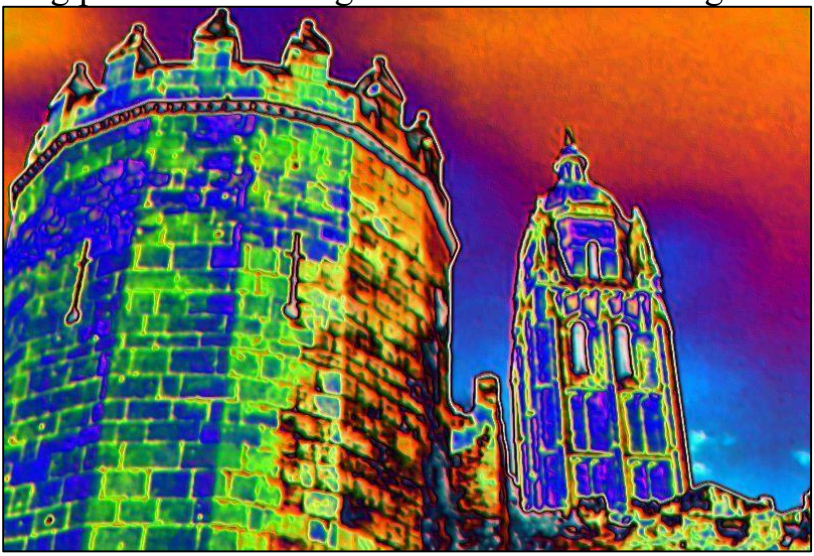
As the man who spoke was suddenly pulled through the opening, the lower moon transformed into a gargoyle and enveloped him; and in an instant, both were gone. I admonished our company to stay away from the fracture and pull back. And as we gave our ground, the rupture changed back into a stone wall. Although no one spoke, we all knew our number was one less than it had been.

Fearfully, everyone started looking for a way out and quickly wandered off in different directions. A great deal happened I only vaguely remember; not enough to make sense of it, but enough to know we were under attack.

Soon or later, it is impossible to say which; I passed through two brightly lit courtyards with rectangular pools tightly packed with crocodiles with long jaws filled with sharp teeth. Sensing they would only attack if I showed

fear, I stepped over them by maintaining my tranquility. Trust me; it was extremely more perilous than it sounds.

Restricted portions of reality changed unexpectedly, sometimes outside my control and other times due to my willed response to the neverending barrage of altered and aberrant actualities. Passages and tunnels unexpectedly appeared and disappeared, and people who were in the wrong place at the wrong time were never seen again.



Alone, I made my way haltingly through the fortress, expecting Belial to attack without warning. To make the game of cat and mouse more stimulating, the devil spawn would have provided us with an outlet, but the chances of finding it were slim to none. So, as I searched through the morphing passages and rooms, it appeared likely I would eventually confront the demon head on.

The next courtyard was filled with a pride of jaguars lying and sitting against each other. And again, I made my way safely between them by not allowing my fear to manifest the negative reality I wanted to avoid.

After a long stone passage, I entered a third courtyard with more jaguars off to my left. Something drew me to the wall on the right where I saw a protruding rectangular stone with a sharpened pyramidal end.

Inspecting the protrusion, I saw numbers inscribed on its surface, and since there was no way to depress it with my hand, I moved it with my will. As the wall morphed

into a nook and then a cavity, I heard a woman's voice I recognized behind me shout, "The numbers total 71!"

Distracted, I noticed two of the people trapped in this lucid dream standing beside me, and without thinking, I let them lead me out of the room. But as we entered the passageway just outside, I realized they were an illusory manifestation to divert me from the room with the transmutating wall; indicating it must be important.

Pulling away from the illusions, I reentered the room where a man in a jackal mask appeared, hooting strident animal cries to rile up the jaguars off to the left. Making use of the mutability of reality myself, I projected a wish for the Anubis-like masked howler to be quieted, and two guards with spears suddenly appeared out of nowhere to forcibly drag him away, never to return.

Alone now with the stirred-up jaguars, I returned to the wall with the odd projecting stone with the pyramidal point, and peered into a cave boring straight through the solid rock. Then unexpectedly without transition, I found myself unpredictably inside the cave mouth looking back into the room, which changed abruptly into a small glade at the edge of a forest wherein my mother now stood.

Awash with unadulterated joy, I ran over to embrace her; and as I touched her form, reality transformed again and I was alone in what looked like a laundry room full of piles of clothes and bed sheets. Now, completely off

balance by the rapid change in reality, I twirled around in dread expecting to confront Belial and awakened instead.

I have no desire to become a demon; and in fact, I try to live my life without taking advantage or impinging on anyone else; thus, reflecting an alignment of ethical good. Nonetheless, I wonder if I take something important from others when I share my ideas in hope of transmitting the wonderment and awe of living that I continuously feel.

Because most success in our world improves with the acquisition of knowledge, it seems foolish to cast away proficiencies already gained, simply because we humans are so ill equipped to exist outside of what we know. In truth, it seems more natural to want to continue to build upon what I know and now am; therefore, I strive to pierce the veil of death; not to come back, but to continue onward, perhaps better prepared, into the obdurate unknown.

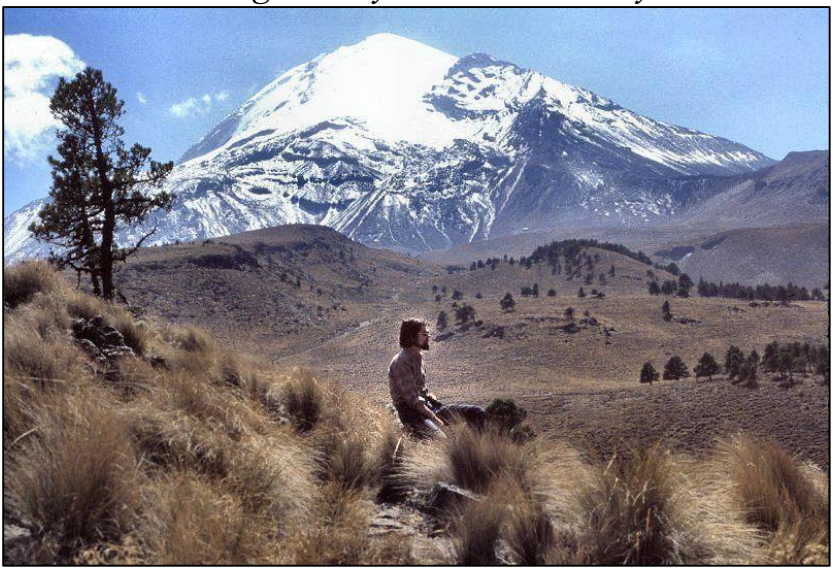
I fully expect my consciousness will be out of context with whatever reality I find around me when I die. But the recognition of its familiarity and the understanding it holds, may keep me sentient long enough to adapt to the environment in which I persevere, so I can more quickly become whatever is next, be it in some heaven or hell, in a reincarnation, or as I suspect; something else entirely beyond the boundaries of my conscious understanding.

As always, I try to follow a path with heart through reality by keeping my eyes fixed on the horizon without

troubling myself with concern for the manifestation my life will take; trusting I can adapt to whatever lies ahead. I may be on a fool's errand, but who cares but me, since I will be the only one who knows what I will experience.

I feel the limitations of corporeality and the decay of change. But based on my expectations, I look forward to shedding my corporeal form. With any luck, it will be a renewing experience; and if not, then,

"*It will be a good day to die. Hoka hey!*"



Still, I think the manifested locale of my above dream was not as important as my apparent comfort level in a reality that changed constantly. This is something I have been training myself to attain throughout my life, so with any luck I hope my efforts will be vindicated.

Belial added the potential element of apprehension to the dream by threatening the obliteration of my spirit as well as my consciousness. And yet despite the morphing realities while being hunted by a major hell-spawn, I dealt with the situation without fear or emotion until the very end. Fascinatingly, in the concluding scene when Belial manifests an illusion of my mother, it provoked such a strong feeling of emotion I was unprotected and undone, and presumably lost. Hence the knowledge I take from this dream is that not only must I be without fear when I die, I also have to be without compassionate sentiments either, for they may actually cloud my perception and distract my consciousness just when I most need to be focused.

Ultimately, writing down my dreams seems to open access to possibilities I cannot otherwise see. Who is to say, at the instant of death we do not determine our fate in the nebulous dream world as the strictures of a fixed reality dissolve? Perhaps, giving in to the dissolution of despair when the physical body is no longer a part of us triggers the lifeforce animating our corporeality to reenter the cosmic pool stripped of conscious memories of what came before. But if I refuse to give in at the moment of my death, my consciousness-ego-id might remain intact and persist, cognizant of my continuity. This possibility offers an optimistic confidence in the potentialities lying just beyond the opaque shroud of life, and may suggest a viable template to maintain my consciousness intact.

It is possible to believe that all the past is but the beginning of a beginning, and all that is and has been is but the twilight of the dawn. It is possible to believe that all that the human mind has ever accomplished is but the dream before the awakening.

H.G. Wells.

5 — Two hypnagogic lucid dreams

One night I had a lucid dream while still awake.

I could easily have slept, but I stayed awake reading to limit the number of hours I waste sleeping. But by the time I went to bed, I caught a second wind and lay there waiting for thoughts racing through my mind to subside.

Abruptly I realized I was looking down at a gridded board symmetrically inlaid with a myriad of tiny objects arrayed in cells no larger than those found on a Parcheesi board, organized in five-inch square grids of eight rows by eight columns. The cells were formed from multiple materials of various shapes, such as glass, crystal, metal,

bone and even flowers all glowing in arrays of inimitably brilliant colors. I noticed when I looked at a specific cell it revolved at a rapid rate, while the objects in the cells adjacent twirled at a slower rate in the opposite direction. Comprehending I was fully conscious yet dreaming; on metaphorically taking an introspective step back to perceive the scene from a distinct perspective, it seemed clear that I lay awake in bed with the same progression of thoughts still running through my contemplations.

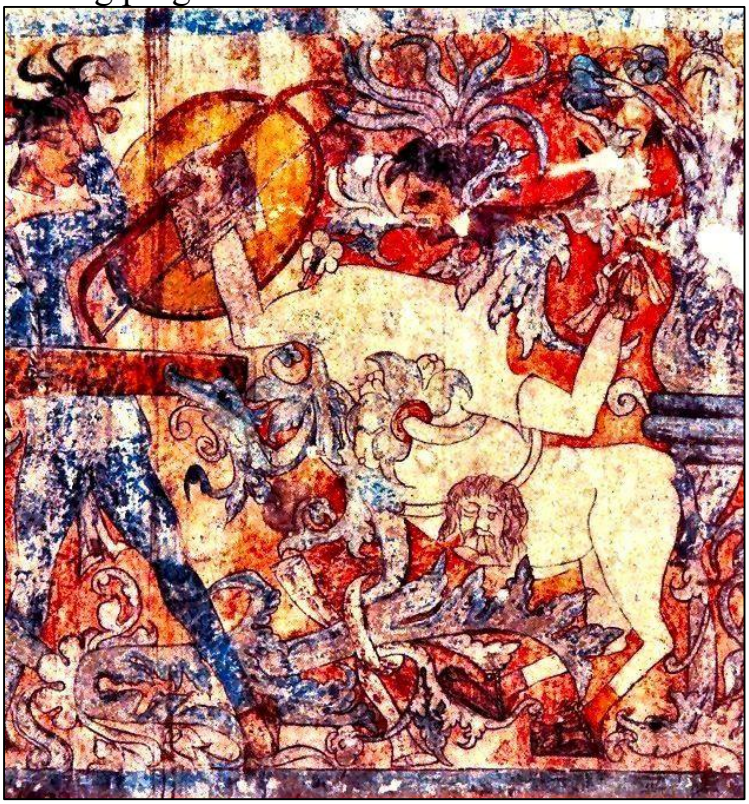
Trying to maintain my delicate balance of awareness, with some difficulty I consciously brought the board of intriguing spinning objects into focus once more, while being aware of the stream of un-quieted thoughts playing in my mind; on the one hand clearly immersed in a lucid dream and on the other, incontestably awake and abed in my ordinary reality.

For a moment, in order to verify I persisted in two unique planes of existentiality synchronously, I purposefully ping ponged my awareness between lying in my bed and my dream vision of the colorful objects gridded on the board. This time they were more difficult to resolve, seemingly as if I murkily observed them from a distance through a telephoto lens. Then at the instant I brought the spinning motions of a 3x3 subsection of the objects into a sharper resolution, the scene vanished entirely and my awareness snapped back to me lying in my bed awake.

This fleeting dream was exceptionally informative for me. It suggested the possibility of dreaming awake, while still maintaining the tether of lucidity connecting the real world with the dream world. If this state of dual reality is reproducible, then lucid dream states might be more easily remembered with the clarity of wakefulness. Perchance because I had originally read about dreamwalking in the 1970s, I never heard of *hypnagogic imagery* until much later when I recounted this dream to a well-read friend who explained it to me. Consequently, while my brief and ephemeral cognitive visualization appeared to conform to the definition of hypnagogic, it surprised me this was the first time I had ever experienced it.

Thinking on it over the next several days, it seemed to me that sleep by definition requires a suspension of consciousness before it can occur, which would suggest reality must emanate from my own awareness rather than persist as an existing construct outside self. But then, how can I experience dreaming, which like tripping on a psychotropic substance, allows me for a limited time to exist in an unrestricted existentiality undefined by the limits normal reality imposes on us when we are awake? Still, why do I continually feel the landscapes within dreams are real and extant? Dreams as we know them are not true memories — unless they are un-recollected memories of other lives lived *a la* reincarnation. But as an author, I know even the greatest writers and movie directors in history cannot create completed documents

and documentaries instantaneously as imaginings in the mind; for such creativity requires weeks or even months of painstaking progressive effort to be manifest.



My main interest in reentering dreams is to look for consistency. If dreams were random imagery occurring when we sleep, then they should be impossible to repeat. But if dreams exist extant on some plane in the quantum universe, then it indicates one's consciousness enters a static and consistent reality matrix. Thus, it is rational to assume that our dreams may occur in parallel or alternate

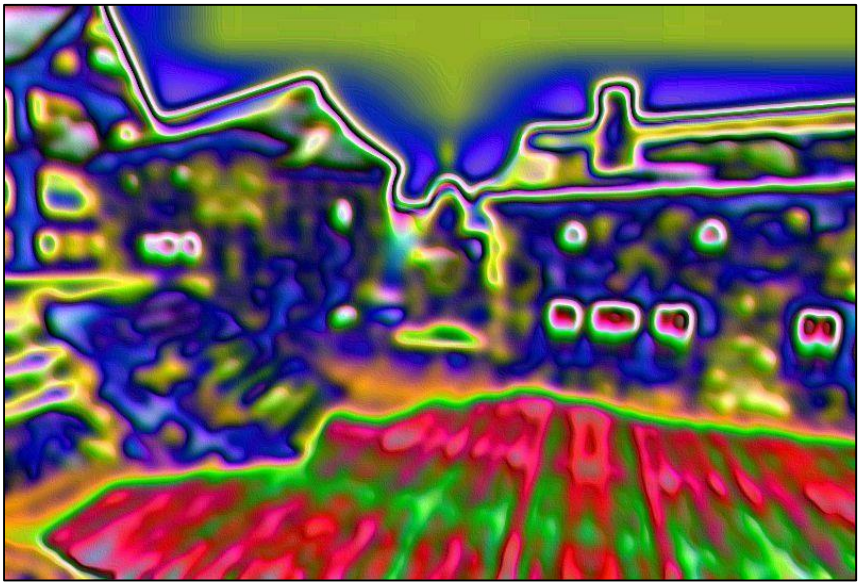
realities, analogous to the Branes proposed by theoretical physicists exploring String Theory; extant within reality, but typically inaccessible to our waking consciousness.

And even if it is only a memory of a dream I reenter; are not recollections only the frames in the framework of real events we no longer animate with consciousness? Subsequently, the fact we can go back and run through dream scenes to embellish original sequences of events, suggests dreams persist in a form no less real than a book we can page through again and again.

Some years later, I was falling asleep while replaying Hawkwind's hard rock music album, *In Search of Space*, in my rapt recollection, when another hypnagogic dream involving static imagery unexpectedly transpired.

The colorful photographic image of a curled up baby painted on a dinner plate unexpectedly appeared before my eyes; quickly replaced by a series of white geometric three dimensional shapes made of twisted wire suspended in midair against a shadowy gray background. Checking my metaphysical placement in reality, I could still hear Hawkwind playing in my mind, and I firmly felt my body lying in a bed — plainly, simultaneously still awake, and yet indisputably synchronously immersed in a dream.

Hypnagogic dreams are weirdly real, indeed.



6 — The 'Guardians of the Common Reality'

An odd happenstance began occurring the year before I sold our home at Singing Stones for the first time; when the first in a series of sixty dreams intermittently dreamt over the next 25 years came to me in my sleep, wherein I operated as a member of a squad I named *The Guardians of the Common Reality*. In the initial dream, a personage I came to identify as the Commander, asked me to assist a group of supra-conscious life forms fully-proficient at functioning within any alternate or aberrant reality.

Since it was a dream, I willingly agreed; never fully comprehending I committed myself to a bizarre series of exceptionally lucid hallucinations in which I and two or

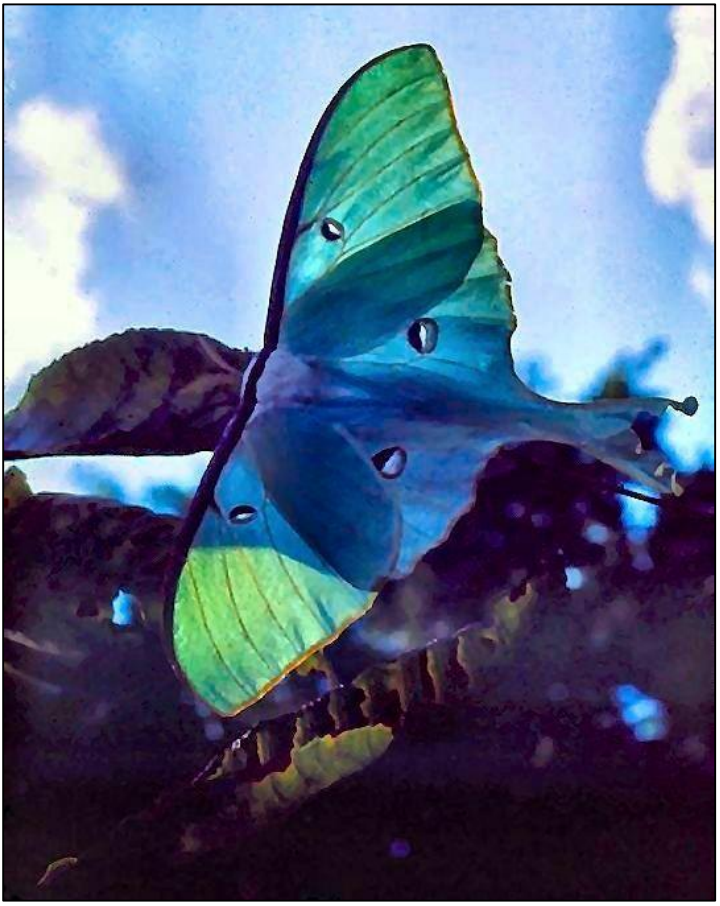
three other conscious entities, not necessarily humanoid, were sent to squelch and repair reality-rifts endangering the perpetuation of life in one of the universes within our purview. In that first dream the Commander taught me how to travel to a time and space in any universe in the multiverse by consciously willing myself to teleport to a mission marker he placed, where an out-of-control or overcharged conscious being was either spewing random destruction or sucking reality into itself like a black hole. Once there, I was expected to do what I did best; that is to assimilate an instantaneous future happenstance to quiet the perturbations emanating from the threat. Or as a last resort, confine the unrestrained and unbridled entity in a shielded and impenetrable shell to limit its influence. Meanwhile, my associates would endeavor to repair the collateral damage to other proximate conscious entities unlucky enough to be within range of the outburst or inburst, by literally trans-positioning *time* to resurrect the innocent victims in cases where recovery was possible.

Most of my numerous missions concerned conscious entities I cannot describe even though I can distinctly see them in my contemporary recollection; for I do not have the vocabulary to describe their appearance or attributes. But I can relate an operation wherein the reality-rift was spawned by a small group of iconoclasts in our universe, dominated by an overweight autocrat surrounded by bags of a psychotropic substance that he ate like bits of candy as fast as he could shovel the tablets into his mouth.

Concurrently with two associates, I materialized on a narrow street in what appeared to be a European village, and we climbed an outside stairway to a second story flat where we simply passed through the wall to obtain entry. The room lay in disarray as the occupants were only just being sucked towards the metaphorical maw of the obese tyrant at its center, so we stopped the obliteration before any loss of life occurred. Empathizing with the plaintive dread the despot emitted to have so lost his desire to live he intended to destroy reality, I readily assimilated him unconscious; for he truly wanted to escape his misery.

Most times, the conscious entities causing the reality rifts were not human or humanoid, so the spatial realities surrounding me were nearly impossible to comprehend. Consequently, I had to focus exclusively on dampening the

sensed aberrant motility of reality, a characteristic unfailingly extant at the locus of every rift of destruction I witnessed. My work ended once I dampened the danger, so I did not remain for cleanup. Otherwise, peculiarities within these inexplicable universes might have adversely affected my consciousness no less than it did the entities I confronted.

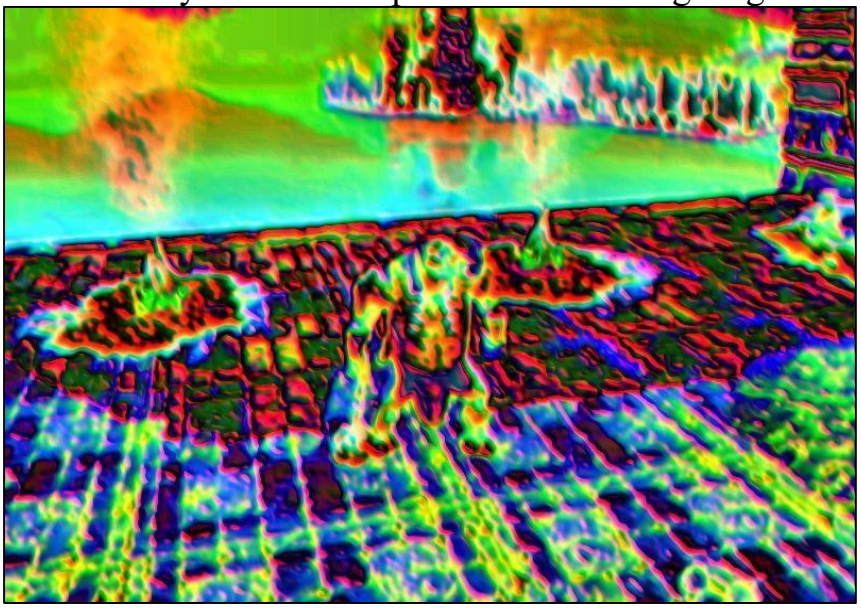


In all the occasions I found myself engaging in one of these lucid dream missions, I never tried to ascertain how the Commander knew about the rifts in reality so rapidly; and for that matter, what his true appearance or degree of dimensional transcendency might be, to be aware of so many universes simultaneously. But whatever he was, it certainly was well above the seven levels of dimensional awareness I could intellectually comprehend. So, as far as I was concerned I was glad to be kept in the dark. And it was enough for me just to be bidden to the dance; even if I was unable to fathom how, what or where we danced.

On three occasions, the entities I faced and the rifts they generated were more than I could handle, and the Commander himself appeared 'in the flesh' to deal with an overpowering threat. I qualify *in the flesh* because the human form he customarily projected for my perception intermittently metamorphed into an amorphous mistiness during the fray. And in one of these instances, the being we faced was more than the Commander could constrain, so two Commander-like beings materialized to assist us in quelling the crazed entity causing so much destruction.

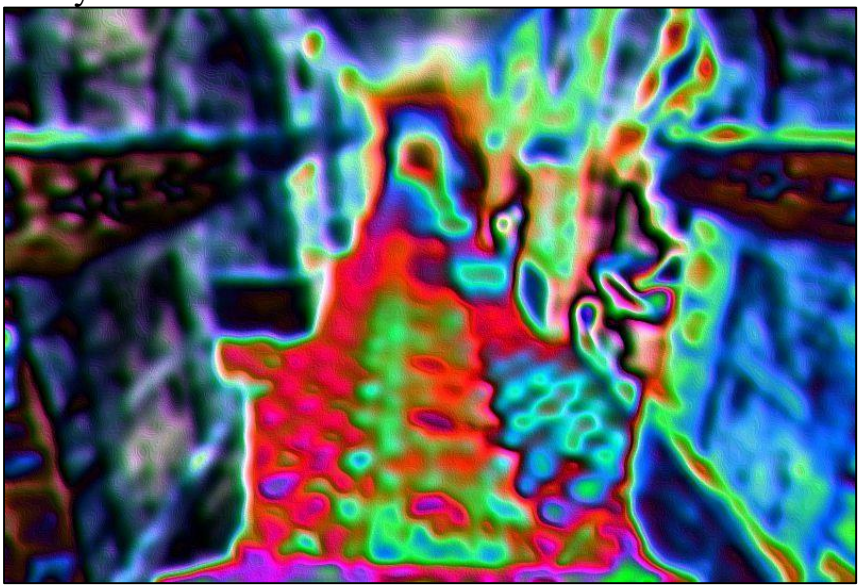
That struggle persisted for so long I doubted I would survive. Still, even if I proved to be the weak link in our defense and ultimately fell, I endeavored to warrant my failure could never be attributed to a lack of fortitude. Therefore, I assiduously added my inadequate powers to the ostensibly all-powerful competencies of the triad of transcendent consciousnesses attending me, much like an

ant might carry a grain of sand to help a team of monster bulldozers build a small mountain, until we repaired the rent in reality's fabric and put that universe right again.



I have no delusions that my 4-dimensional awareness was physically teleporting through the multiverse in a semblance of waking reality. But being well-versed in the intricacies of all altered states of awareness, I know everything we experience consciously, even our dreams; are real if we believe them to be, shaped by perceptivity. So whether my *Guardian Missions* were simple dreams or credibly syncopated rhythms pulsating from a higherdimensional me persisting extant outside time; because they appeared real, their causal effect on my

psyche was the same as anything occurring in my waking reality.

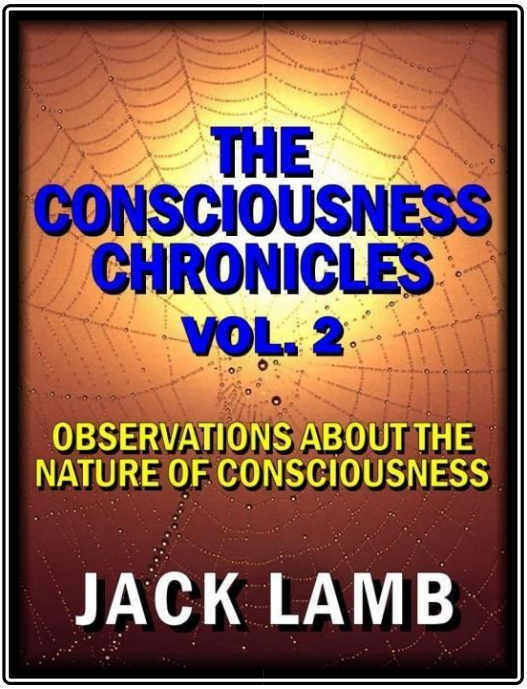


In these dreams, I perceived the harsh understanding that each of us is but a *suspension of disbelief* away from a burnout analogous to what those out-of-control ultraconscious entities in other disparate universes endured, if we are unprepared when we stumble on the true power of deific consciousness that is our legacy. For, if we cannot exercise the restraint these godlike powers demand, then we could suffer a comparable fate and burnout. And like a roman candle fizzling out after a fleeting flush of fiery ejaculation, or a falling star winking out after streaming a scorching trail across the night sky; we consume the sum of our lifespan's energies, which might have powered us through untold future wonderments of

existentiality, in a transitory flash of abdication as our sentience expires.

The chronicles continue in…

THE CONSCIOUSNESS CHRONICLES Volume Two


THE
CONSCIOUSNESS
CHRONICLES
VOL. 2
OBSERVATIONS ABOUT THE
NATURE OF CONSCIOUSNESS
JACK LAMB